



HOW TO – IN THE CAUSAL MAP APP. INTRODUCTION

CHAPTER CONTENTS.

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In this chapter we look at some examples of specific workflows in causal mapping, mostly illustrated with the Causal Map app. It's work in progress, we only have a couple of pages at this point.

If you want to know about how to answer specific questions with causal mapping, look here:

[Individual questions — introduction](#)

PAGES IN THIS CHAPTER

Example views (example-original)

The public **example-original** project in the Causal Map app is a real, anonymised QuIP-style dataset. It is useful when you want to see what a **busy** map looks like after serious coding, and how filters change the picture. Screenshots below are exported from **saved bookmarks** (stable image files in this vault; open the matching bookmark in the app to reproduce the exact filter state).

Manually code your first project

This page walks you through manually coding the practice project that every new user gets, called **example-short-uncoded**. The aim is to take you from "I just signed up" to "I have a small map I made myself", in around

twenty minutes. If you'd rather have the AI code it for you, see the AI coding walk-through (separate page); if you want to know why we code the way we do, see [[0.001 Task 2 -- Introduction|Task 2 introduction]].

Bulk relabelling factors

Sooner or later, every project ends up with a pile of slightly different factor labels for the same idea: **feels frustrated, feeling frustrated, frustration, gets frustrated**. This page covers the four ways to clean that up in bulk, when to reach for which, and how to use the same tools to convert flat labels into hierarchical ones.

Formatting your map for what you want to show

A causal map is meant to make a point, not to be a faithful echo of the data. This page covers the controls that decide what shows up on the map and how each thing looks, organised by the question you're trying to answer rather than by which widget does what. The widget-by-widget reference lives in [[130 Map Panel ((map-panel))|the Map Panel page]] and [[100 Filter Links tab ((filter-link-tab))|the Filter Links tab page]].

Print view of links

The **Print view of links** is for evidence checking. A map

Translate factor labels

This is easy with AI Answers in Factors mode.

Vignettes

Some people love just staring at a map and clicking the links to view the quotes behind them. Other people are like "No, what does it say, tell me in actual words already!"

Different kinds of coding and recoding

What's the point of Links and Factors recoding? What's the difference?

Adding and using custom columns for your links

Custom link columns let you store extra information on each causal claim, beyond the standard fields like **sentiment** and **tags**.

Recoding labels temporarily

Sometimes you want to improve your factor labels (cause and effect text) without changing the original data. You might want to:

Comparing groups

Do men mention X more than women? Do project A respondents talk about different consequences than project B? This page sketches the methods you'll usually use in the Causal Map app, then goes into detail on the quickest one (the Factors table) and on what "significant" means when the app flags a difference.